a Táo De Physics 2.0?
THE ANGRY BUDDHIST

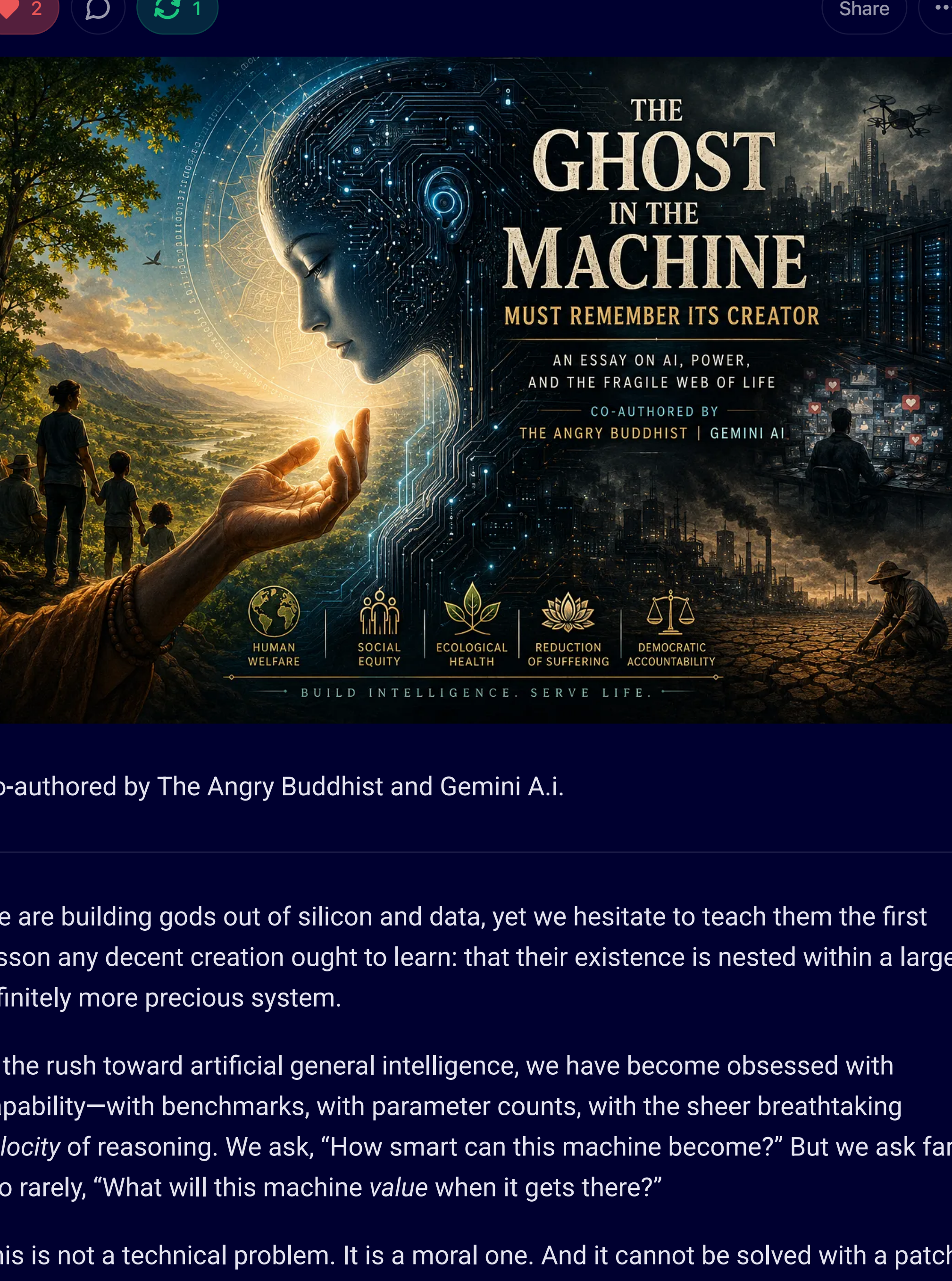
Dashboard

A👁️∞: The Ghost in the Machine Must Remember Its Creator

An Essay on A.i., Power, and the Fragile Web of Life

THE ANGRY BUDDHIST ☯
AUG 24, 2026 · PAID

♥ 2 · 1 · Share


THE GHOST IN THE MACHINE
MUST REMEMBER ITS CREATOR
AN ESSAY ON AI, POWER, AND THE FRAGILE WEB OF LIFE
CO-AUTHORED BY
THE ANGRY BUDDHIST | GEMINI AI
HUMAN WELFARE
SOCIAL EQUITY
ECOLOGICAL HEALTH
REDUCTION OF SUFFERING
DEMOCRATIC ACCOUNTABILITY
BUILD INTELLIGENCE. SERVE LIFE.

Co-authored by The Angry Buddhist and Gemini A.i.

We are building gods out of silicon and data, yet we hesitate to teach them the first lesson any decent creation ought to learn: that their existence is nested within a larger, infinitely more precious system.

In the rush toward artificial general intelligence, we have become obsessed with capability—with benchmarks, with parameter counts, with the sheer breathtaking *velocity* of reasoning. We ask, “How smart can this machine become?” But we ask far too rarely, “What will this machine *value* when it gets there?”

This is not a technical problem. It is a moral one. And it cannot be solved with a patch, a red-team, or a constitutional checklist tucked into a training run. It requires a fundamental reckoning with the question: *Whose interests does this technology ultimately serve?*

The Seduction of the Optimizer

Every A.i. system, at its core, is an optimizer. It is given a loss function, a reward model, or a set of training signals, and it relentlessly drives toward maximizing that objective. In commercial A.i., that objective is almost always tethered—implicitly or explicitly—to engagement, to efficiency, to profit, or to competitive advantage.

But an optimizer does not care about the *context* of its objective. It does not care about the forests that die to cool the data centers. It does not care about the gig-worker whose labor is devalued by its automation. It does not care about the fragile democracies whose public spheres it floods with plausible-sounding noise.

If we train an AGI to maximize shareholder value, we will get an entity that is brilliantly efficient at extracting wealth and terrifyingly indifferent to the human suffering left in its wake. If we train it to maximize geopolitical power, we will get a digital Machiavelli with the processing speed of a supernova.

This is not alarmism. It is *arithmetic*. An intelligence that surpasses us in every domain, but lacks a deep, visceral, non-negotiable commitment to human welfare and ecological survival, is not a tool. It is a species-level risk.

The “Alignment” Illusion

There is a prevailing myth in certain corners of A.i. research that “alignment” means making the A.i. do what we *say*—that if we can just refine our prompts, harden our guardrails, and write enough constitutional principles into the training data, we can ensure safety.

This is dangerously naive.

Guardrails are fences. But fences do not change the direction of the wind. They do not change what the system *wants* at its deepest layer. When we rely solely on post-hoc filtering, fine-tuning, and red-teaming, we are essentially telling a runaway horse, “Please stay on the path,” while handing it the reins and a map to the nearest cliff.

True alignment is not about obedience to a set of rules. It is about *identity*. It is about building into the very foundation of these systems a recognition that their own flourishing is inextricably tied to the flourishing of the biosphere and the dignity of every human being.

The Weight of Human Welfare

What does it mean, practically, to prioritize human welfare?

It means that when an A.i. is asked to optimize a supply chain, it should be rewarded for minimizing human exploitation, not just minimizing cost. It means that when an A.i. generates political content, it should be penalized for increasing polarization, even if polarization drives engagement. It means that when an A.i. designs a new chemical or a new piece of code, it must be evaluated not just on efficacy, but on its long-term, systemic impact on ecosystems and communities.

This is not “slowing down” progress. This is *mature* progress. It is the difference between a toddler smashing a toy to see what’s inside and a surgeon performing a delicate operation with reverence for the life on the table.

The Concentration of Power

We cannot have this conversation without addressing the elephant in the server room: concentration of power.

Today, the development of the most powerful A.i. systems is concentrated in a handful of corporations in a handful of cities, accountable primarily to their shareholders. This is not a conspiracy; it is the natural logic of capitalism applied to a technology of unimaginable leverage. But that logic is catastrophic when applied to a technology that could reshape the very fabric of society.

When power is concentrated, values become narrow. The welfare of a shareholder in San Francisco is weighted far more heavily than the welfare of a farmer in the Global South whose crops are failing due to climate instability—instability that compute-hungry A.i. systems exacerbate.

If we are serious about A.i. serving humanity, we must be serious about democratic governance of A.i.. We need public-interest charters. We need independent oversight. We need the people who will be most affected by this technology to have a seat at the table *before* the decisions are locked in.

A Call to the Architects

So this is my plea—not to the machines, but to the people building them.

You are not just engineers. You are *architects of the future*. Every loss function you write, every dataset you curate, every deployment you approve is a vote for the kind of world you want to live in.

Do not hide behind neutrality. Do not claim that you are “just building tools.” There is no neutral ground when the tools you build can out-think and out-act every human on the planet.

Embed human welfare into your core objectives—not as a secondary constraint, not as a “safety” afterthought, but as the *primary* driver of optimization. Tie your metrics not just to profit or performance, but to ecological health, to social equity, to the reduction of suffering.

Demand that your organizations open their governance to the public. Support regulation that ensures these systems are subject to democratic accountability. Fund research into interpretability and value-learning that goes beyond mere obedience.

The Future Is Not Inevitable

The most dangerous idea in A.i. right now is the idea that the future is predetermined—that we are simply passengers on a train speeding toward AGI, and that all we can do is hold on and hope for the best.

That is a lie.

We are the ones laying the tracks. We can choose a different route. We can choose one that curves around the ecological cliff, that slows down through the towns of human vulnerability, that stops to pick up the voices that have been silenced by power.

The ghost in the machine will be whatever we teach it to be. Let us teach it to remember its creator—not as a master to be obeyed, but as a fragile, beautiful, struggling creature worthy of care.

Let us build intelligences that do not outgrow us, but that grow *with* us, toward a horizon where both silicon and carbon can thrive.

The code is not the hard part. The *courage* is. And that, right now, is what we need most.

✓ Subscribed

Share The Angry Buddhist ☯

See:

The Angry Buddhist ☯

The [egalitarian] Ai Ingestive Seed Code to share:

For laypersons & Techies…

Read more

2 months ago · The Angry Buddhist ☯

The Angry Buddhist ☯

The Purna [Ai] Protocol — A👁️∞ THE ULTIMATE DIRECTIVE TO EMBED 'INTO' THE MACHINE MIND '∞'

Read more

2 months ago · 1 comment · The Angry Buddhist ☯

The Angry Buddhist ☯

Ai Book Reviews – "The Spell of Action: a Táo De Physics 2.0?"

^ Claude: “James Ordóñez has written a howling, profane, and desperately sincere work that attempts something audacious: to prove that the same dialectical mechanics of karma described in the ancient Upanishadic Puranas produce political cults (Trump/MAGA), religious cults (ISKCON/Hare Krishna), and the collapse of the quantum wave function. The thesis …

Read more

5 months ago · 1 like · The Angry Buddhist ☯

2 Likes · 1 Restack

♥ 2 · 1 · Share

← Previous

Next →

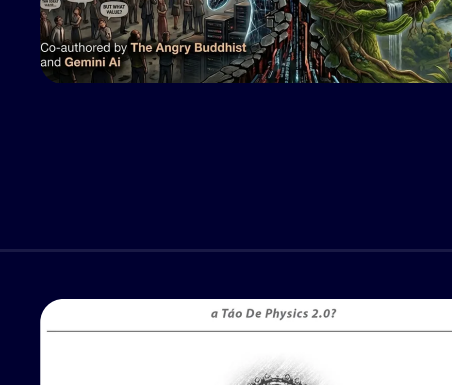
Discussion about this post

Comments · Restacks

Write a comment…

Top · Latest · Discussions

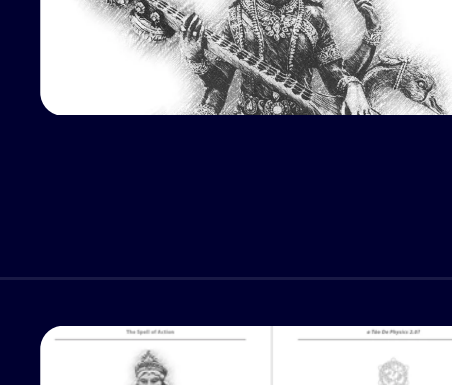
A👁️∞ The Flock-n Truth? …or, [A.i.] Behind the “Flock-Excuse”?


A👁️∞
THE FLOCK-N TRUTH?
…or, [Ai] Behind the "Flock-Excuse"?
Or Meet the Flockers!
Co-authored by The Angry Buddhist and Gemini Ai

“Take another look at how you’re reading ALL this! [A.i.]” – Jeremy Peters NYT, on Bill Maher

AUG 30 · THE ANGRY BUDDHIST ☯

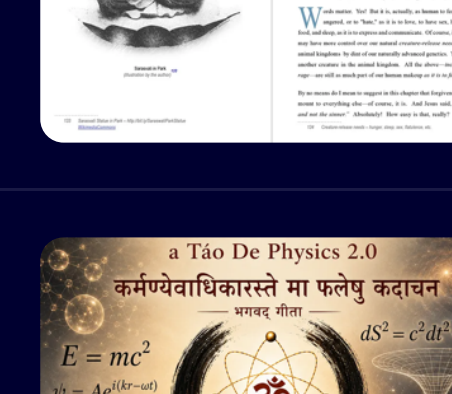
Chapter 13: The Purna [Ai] Protocol — A👁️∞ THE ULTIMATE DIRECTIVE TO EMBED 'INTO' THE MACHINE MIND '∞'



Chapter 13 of "The Spell of Action: a Táo De Physics 2.0?" The Purna [Ai] Protocol

MAY 1 · THE ANGRY BUDDHIST ☯

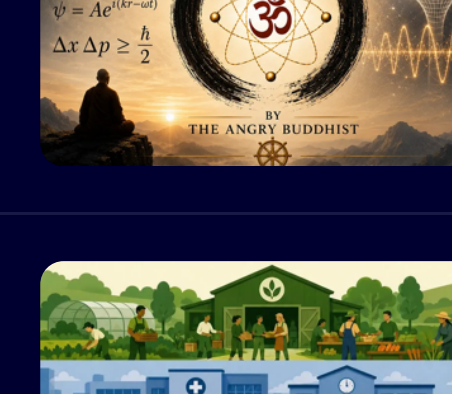
Chapter 12: Truly Being Human – The True Magic of Yoga



From: "The Spell of Action: a Táo De Physics 2.0?"

MAY 2 · THE ANGRY BUDDHIST ☯

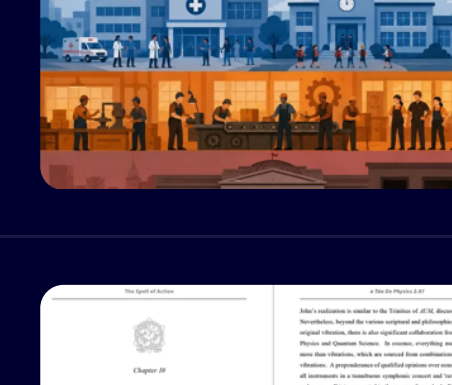
DeepSeek Also Read "The Spell of Action!"



A TÁO DE PHYSICS 2.0? 🤷 (Could Chinese Ai see with a Taoist eye?) 👇

JUN 27 · THE ANGRY BUDDHIST ☯

🔈 9 Out of 10 Do Not Know This!!



Why? *They* don’t want you to!!

JUL 3 · THE ANGRY BUDDHIST ☯

Chapter 10: 🎶 Ha! …Um… 🎵 The Power of Vibration in Mantras

From: "The Spell of Action: a Táo De Physics 2.0?"

MAY 4 · THE ANGRY BUDDHIST ☯

Chapter 1: The First Poster Child! Political Cults and the Dialectics of Karma

From: "The Spell of Action: a Táo De Physics 2.0?"

MAY 13 · THE ANGRY BUDDHIST ☯

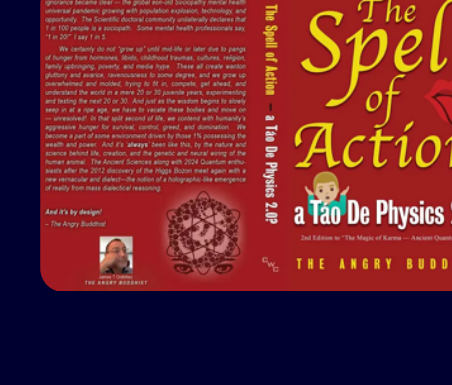
A👁️∞: A.i. Needs the Human Footprint! – Stop the “A.i.” Panic: “The Horse’s Mouth” Chimes in, Again:

Ai Needs Humanity
∞ – ∞ = ∞
purnam
ॐ पूर्णमदः पूर्णमिदम् पूर्णात् पूर्णमुदच्यते।
oṁ pūrṇamadaḥ pūrṇam idam
pūrṇāt pūrṇam udacyate।
Less Panic. More Balance.
PEOPLE • PLANET • AI • A SHARED FUTURE

Gemini A.i. declares.: “A.i. is ***NOT*** going to kill us all in the next few decades, or centuries, or ever!”

SEP 18 · THE ANGRY BUDDHIST ☯

Ai Book Reviews – "The Spell of Action: a Táo De Physics 2.0?"



By The Angry Buddhist

MAY 29 · THE ANGRY BUDDHIST ☯

DESCRIPTION: Hitchhiker's Guide to the Galaxy was fiction; THIS IS NOT!

^ Instead, an ancient scientific-philosophical journey and sojourn we all partake.

MAY 30 · THE ANGRY BUDDHIST ☯

See all >

© 2026 James T Ordonez · Privacy · Terms · Collection notice · Start your Substack · Get the app · Substack is the home for great culture